

NATASHA JACOBSEN

Strategic Account Executive · Life Sciences & AI

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\$8.5M

Capital Sales — FY2025

\$4.2M

TCV Enterprise Contract

13+

Years Life Sciences

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

President's Club enterprise sales leader with a proven track record of exceeding revenue targets across pharmaceutical companies, biotechnology firms, academic institutions, and CROs. In FY2025: \$8.5M in capital closed, a \$4.2M TCV multi-year enterprise contract co-negotiated, and a \$14M reagent territory supported. An active adopter of AI tools for commercial productivity, using Claude, ChatGPT, and Microsoft Copilot 365 for account research, NIH and biotech funding identification, publication-based outreach, and pipeline optimization. Able to engage life sciences customers in confident, informed discussions on the ML and AI capabilities of advanced instrumentation platforms and their applications to drug discovery and clinical development. Grounded by 7 years as an R&D scientist with deep expertise in cell biology, CRISPR gene editing, and laboratory automation, with extensive Fisher Scientific VAR channel experience and a committed belief in the ethical development of frontier AI for scientific and clinical applications.

CORE COMPETENCIES

▶ Enterprise Life Sciences Sales	▶ Full Sales Cycle Ownership (Outbound to Close)
▶ AI-Augmented Commercial Productivity	▶ SaaS, Capital and Consumables Enterprise Sales
▶ Pharma, Biotech, Academic and CRO Accounts	▶ R&D, Regulatory and C-Suite Navigation
▶ Multi-Year Contract Negotiation	▶ Channel Partner and VAR Management (Fisher Scientific)
▶ Scientific and Technical Credibility	▶ Cross-Functional Commercial Execution
▶ Life Sciences Procurement and Buying Cycles	▶ Strategic Market Expansion and NPI Leadership

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Waters Biosciences

October 2023 – Present

Research Instrumentation Sales Specialist · Southern California · Arizona · Hawaii

- President's Club FY2025: Closed \$8.5M in capital sales with >70% service attachment rate (~\$2.5M upfront plus recurring revenue) across a \$14M reagents territory, exceeding revenue quotas through strategic account expansion, competitive conversions, and multi-year platform adoption across pharmaceutical companies, biotechnology firms, academic institutions, CROs, and biopharma organizations
- Co-led negotiation of a \$4.2M TCV multi-year enterprise contract with an academic account (capital + consumables + service, with structured YoY revenue escalation), navigating complex life sciences procurement frameworks, R&D budgeting processes, and compliance requirements across multiple internal and customer stakeholders
- Managed deep channel partner relationships with Fisher Scientific across all accounts, coordinating with dozens of Fisher reps, life sciences specialists, and regional managers to co-navigate complex deals, accommodate customer purchasing preferences, organize joint seminars, and drive pull-through across the full product portfolio
- Led the US sales team in FACSDiscover™ S8 & A8 placements, an imaging-integrated flow cytometry platform representing a new product category in life sciences, demonstrating early NPI performance and consultative sales excellence across pharmaceutical, biotech, and academic accounts
- Engages life sciences customers in consultative discussions on the ML and AI capabilities of the FACSDiscover™ platform, including automated cell population analysis and imaging-integrated workflows, partnering with applications specialists to address advanced scientific questions supporting drug discovery and clinical development
- Gathered and conveyed market needs from researchers, scientists, and R&D leaders to internal product and applications teams, informing product roadmap priorities, sales methodology refinement, and value proposition for the life sciences market

- Organized the inaugural BD FACSDiscover™ Symposium at UCSD's Sanford Consortium, a full-day KOL-driven scientific program with invited industry and academic speakers, recognized internally as the model for future customer engagement programs
- Orchestrated a networked selling model across capital, reagent, applications, and service teams, owning the full sales cycle from outbound prospecting through strategic close, driving coordinated territory execution and ecosystem pull-through
- Executed 50+ customer seminars and educational events across pharmaceutical, biotech, academic, and CRO accounts, driving competitive positioning and new account development from bench scientists to R&D leadership and C-suite
- Leverages AI tools for commercial productivity, using Claude, ChatGPT, Microsoft Copilot 365, and Perplexity for account research, NIH and biotech/pharma funding identification, publication-based personalized outreach, pipeline-driven travel optimization, and call preparation
- Expert in Salesforce CRM (pipeline governance, forecasting, deal reviews), Power BI (territory analytics), and LinkedIn Sales Navigator (account intelligence and prospecting)

Thermo Fisher Scientific

July 2019 – October 2023

Senior Technical Sales Specialist — Flow Cytometry & Cell Sorting Instrumentation · SF Bay Area · Pacific Northwest · Western USA & Canada

- Earned Sales Master (2022) following Sales Achiever in 2020 and 2021, three consecutive years exceeding revenue quotas with double-digit YoY growth across pharmaceutical companies, biotechnology firms, academic institutions, and research organizations throughout the Western US and Canada
- Achieved >65% demonstration-to-close conversion rate for three consecutive years on the Attune™ NxT platform, navigating complex sales cycles through competitive evaluations, technical seminars, and independently delivered demos to diverse life sciences audiences from bench scientists to R&D leadership
- Managed Fisher Scientific channel partner relationships across all major accounts, including the University of California system, training Fisher life sciences specialists on product capabilities, routing deals through preferred purchasing channels, and coordinating multi-rep engagements to drive revenue capture
- Led a cross-functional initiative with leadership, product management, and regional TSSs to develop and execute a targeted cell and gene therapy strategy, leveraging the full Thermo Fisher life sciences portfolio to drive coordinated growth across pharmaceutical and biotech organizations
- Managed split compensation across capital and service attachment, coordinating with three reagent specialists across Bay Area, Pacific Northwest, and Western Canada, driving revenue beyond the initial instrument sale across complex multi-stakeholder accounts
- Organized a large-scale scientific seminar and collaborated with internal subject matter experts through the Scientist-to-Scientist (S2S) program, connecting pharmaceutical and research customers with tailored scientific expertise to resolve complex technical challenges and deepen strategic relationships
- Expanded scope to the Bigfoot™ Spectral Cell Sorter (2023), transitioning to cover the entire Western US, demonstrating rapid product mastery and ability to scale commercially in a new and highly specialized instrument market
- Formally mentored new TSSs and Sales Development Program participants; selected by management to interview sales candidates, demonstrating leadership and investment in team commercial excellence

Thermo Fisher Scientific

September 2012 – July 2019

Scientist III · Cell Engineering & Gene-Editing · Carlsbad, CA

- Biological and workflow architect for the Invitrogen™ LentiArray™ CRISPR library, *The Scientist* Top 10 Innovations 2016 & 2018, including full automation pipeline (liquid handler programming, clone-picker integration, custom LIMS), built in direct collaboration with AstraZeneca (target identification) and Biogen (custom library development), establishing enterprise pharmaceutical partnerships at the scientific level
- Core technical lead for GeneArt™ Genomic Cleavage Detection & Selection Kits: drove development from component design through manufacturing transfer across CRISPR, Cas9 Protein, TrueTag™, and TrueDesign™ portfolios; V&V lead on select launches
- Designed and led high-throughput flow cytometry assays as the primary analytical platform across the gene-editing portfolio, with automated data management pipelines (custom LIMS, liquid handler integration) enabling efficient sample processing and data integrity at scale
- Lean Six Sigma Green Belt, led two PPI projects delivering measurable process and throughput improvements: cell line engineering workflow optimization and full lab automation remodel
- Maintained shared flow cytometry and cell sorting facility for 50+ scientists: instrument qualification, preventive maintenance, and hands-on training alongside a full-time R&D role
- Selected by VP-level leadership of the Cellular Biology and Protein & Cell Analysis divisions to serve as the subject matter expert on a cross-functional team evaluating new technologies in flow cytometry, cell sorting, and cell analysis, providing scientific and commercial assessment to inform Thermo Fisher's strategic product portfolio decisions

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Health Sciences — Molecular, Cellular & Developmental Biology

University of California, Santa Cruz · Cum Laude

TECHNICAL & COMMERCIAL SKILLS

AI & Productivity:	Claude, ChatGPT, Microsoft Copilot 365, Perplexity, applied to account research, NIH/biotech/pharma funding identification, publication-based personalized outreach, pipeline optimization, and call preparation
Commercial Tools:	Salesforce CRM (pipeline governance, forecasting, deal reviews), Power BI (territory analytics), LinkedIn Sales Navigator; Fisher Scientific VAR and channel partner management
Scientific:	Flow cytometry, imaging-integrated cell sorting, CRISPR gene editing, genomics, FlowJo, JMP, laboratory automation (Tecan, Biomek liquid handlers), Lean Six Sigma Green Belt

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS & PRESENTATIONS

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATION

Liang, X., Potter, J., **Roark, N.**, Kumar, S., Ravinder, N., & Chesnut, J. D. (2015). Rapid and highly efficient mammalian cell engineering via Cas9 protein transfection. *Journal of Biotechnology*, 208, 44–53

INVITED TALKS

Roark, N. *Accelerating gene editing research using the power of flow cytometry*. Invited talk, CYTO, ISAC Annual Conference

Roark, N. *Flow cytometry applications in the genome editing workflow*. Invited talk, *FlowTex*

WEBINAR

Roark, N. (2020). *Level up your CRISPR gene editing workflow using flow cytometry*. Thermo Fisher Scientific / LabRoots. Most-attended flow cytometry and gene-editing webinar in Thermo Fisher's national program

COMMUNITY LEADERSHIP & SERVICE

Thermo Fisher Scientific — Community Action Council & Employee Resource Group

2012 – 2023

Core Member, STEM Education, Community Programs & ERG

- Led K–12 STEM outreach across multiple years at the San Diego Festival of Science & Engineering Expo Day at Petco Park, classroom visits as a working scientist across San Diego, and laboratory facility tours and on-site student hosting events at Thermo Fisher Scientific; served on the STEM grant selection committee evaluating and awarding funding to community science education organizations; co-organized the company-wide Thermo Fisher Day of Service
- Individually organized annual blood drives in partnership with the San Diego Blood Bank and annual food drives in partnership with the Jacobs & Cushman San Diego Food Bank
- Active ERG member, delivered content and co-facilitated sessions at the annual national sales meeting; collaborated with ERG leadership to plan, develop, and present programming for colleagues and senior leadership

Additional Community Service

Jacobs & Cushman San Diego Food Bank · Community volunteer, fundraising events, and direct food bank operations · 2007–2019

Hospice by the Sea · Provided compassionate respite support to hospice patients and their families · 2007–2008